GO-TO-MARKET PLAN · MAY 2026

Getting Pelikn into every kitchen

A phased market entry strategy targeting independent UK food businesses, built around low-cost acquisition, strong retention and natural expansion revenue.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The plan in four numbers

A focused, capital-efficient go-to-market targeting independent UK hospitality venues through a combination of organic content, referral partnerships and targeted outbound.

180k
TARGET VENUES IN UK

£45
TARGET CAC

6
ACQUISITION CHANNELS

24mo
PATH TO £480K ARR

Phase 1 — Seed

Q2–Q3 2026 · 0–100 venues

Beta programme with hand-picked venues. Gather feedback, refine onboarding, prove retention. Seed word-of-mouth.

Phase 2 — Scale

Q4 2026 · 100–300 venues

Activate paid channels, referral programme and EHO consultant partnerships. First outbound sales motion.

Phase 3 — Expand

H1 2027 · 300–1,000+ venues

Full marketing engine running. Trade show presence. Ireland expansion. Enterprise/group account motion.

TARGET CUSTOMER

Who we're selling to

Independent venue managers and owners who are drowning in operational admin and one bad EHO visit away from a very bad month.

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE

Business type	**Independent restaurant, cafe, pub or hotel**
Team size	**3–40 staff**
Locations	**1–5 sites**
Geography	**UK & Ireland**
Tech comfort	**Low–medium (uses WhatsApp, smartphone)**
Current tools	**Paper / Excel / fragmented apps**

💪 The Decisive Manager

Had a stressful EHO visit. Knows they need to digitise. Looking for something simple that doesn't cost a fortune. Will trial anything with a free period.

💥 The Time-Pressed Owner

Running the floor, managing staff, doing admin. Rotas take a whole Sunday morning. Wants to give it to a senior member of staff and not think about it again.

🏢 The Multi-Site Operator

Has 2–5 sites. Compliance and rotas are chaos to manage centrally. High willingness to pay for something that gives them oversight across sites.

POSITIONING & MESSAGING

The message that cuts through

Every message anchored to the same fear: a failed EHO inspection. The aspiration: running a venue where nothing slips.

CORE POSITIONING STATEMENT

"Pelikn is the only operations platform that gives independent hospitality venues EHO-grade compliance records, a full rota and timesheet system, and real-time visibility of their team — for less than £1 a day."

VENUE OWNER

Stop worrying about EHO

Your compliance records are always complete, always timestamped, always exportable. You're ready for inspection every day, not just when you remember to check.

VENUE MANAGER

Get your Sunday back

Build the rota in minutes, not hours. Staff see it instantly, request swaps in-app, and clock in and out without you chasing anyone on WhatsApp.

MULTI-SITE OPERATOR

See everything from anywhere

One dashboard shows compliance scores, labour costs, and operational status across all your sites. Spot problems before they become headlines.

ACQUISITION CHANNELS

Six ways to reach venue managers

A mix of inbound content, referral partnerships and targeted outbound designed to keep CAC below £45 at scale.

SEO & Content Marketing

PRIMARY

Guides on EHO prep, HACCP templates, allergen compliance. Targets high-intent searches from managers looking to digitise. Builds evergreen traffic with low marginal cost.

EHO Consultant Partnerships

PRIMARY

EHO consultants advise hundreds of venues. A white-label or referral arrangement turns each consultant into a recurring pipeline source. Revenue share model.

Referral Programme

SECONDARY

1 month free for every venue referred. Hospitality is a tight-knit community. Word-of-mouth within local business networks has very low CAC.

Trade Shows & Events

SECONDARY

Hospitality industry events: Pub & Bar Show, Restaurant & Bar Tech Live, Food & Drink Expo. Live demos convert high-intent visitors efficiently.

Outbound Email & LinkedIn

SCALING

Targeted cold outreach to venue managers and group operators. Focus on multi-site accounts (£55+/mo). Personalised by venue type and location.

Social & Community

ALWAYS-ON

Behind-the-scenes content, EHO inspection stories, and compliance tips on Instagram and TikTok. Builds brand trust and funnels to free trial.

ACQUISITION FUNNEL

From stranger to paying customer

A 7-day free trial with no card required removes friction. Onboarding takes under 15 minutes, so prospects can evaluate the full product before committing.

Awareness — Finds Pelikn via search, referral, social or event

↓ **~40% click-through** from ad / organic listing to landing page

Interest — Reads landing page, watches demo, reads case study

↓ **~25% trial start** from landing page visit

Trial — 7-day free trial, no card required. Full product access.

↓ **~35% trial-to-paid** conversion after setup completion

Convert — Subscribes to Starter (£5/mo) or Pro (£25/mo)

↓ **~30% upgrade** from Starter to Pro within 3 months

Expand — Adds venues, upgrades tier, refers other owners

£45	7 days	< 15 min	8.4x
BLENDED CAC	FREE TRIAL	ONBOARDING TIME	LTV:CAC

PHASED ROLLOUT

Three phases to 1,000 venues

Each phase has a clear goal, budget envelope and key milestone. Funding unlocks Phases 2 and 3 simultaneously.

Q2–Q3 2026 · 0–100 VENUES

1

Seed — Prove the product

- ✓ Hand-recruit 20 beta venues for free access
- ✓ Gather qualitative feedback on onboarding and core workflows
- ✓ Identify 3–5 highest-value feature requests
- ✓ Activate SEO content engine and referral programme
- ✓ Target: 100 paying venues, <5% monthly churn, NPS > 40

Q4 2026 · 100–300 VENUES

2

Scale — Turn on paid acquisition

- ✓ Launch Google Search Ads targeting EHO & compliance keywords
- ✓ Sign first 3 EHO consultant referral partnerships
- ✓ Hire customer success (part-time) to reduce churn
- ✓ Introduce multi-venue group outbound motion
- ✓ Target: 300 venues, £90k ARR, CAC < £60

H1 2027 · 300–1,000+ VENUES

3

Expand — Full marketing engine

- ✓ Trade show programme (Pub & Bar Show, Restaurant & Bar Tech Live)
- ✓ Expand to Ireland market
- ✓ Launch group/enterprise pricing for 5+ site operators
- ✓ POS integrations (Square, Lightspeed, EPOS Now)
- ✓ Target: 1,000 venues, £300k ARR, Series A pipeline

KPIS & SUCCESS METRICS

How we measure progress

A focused set of leading and lagging indicators to track at weekly, monthly and quarterly cadence.

GROWTH METRICS

METRIC	MONTH 12 TARGET
Paying Venues	300
MRR	£7,500
ARR	£90,000
MoM Revenue Growth	≥ 15%
Trial-to-Paid Rate	≥ 35%
CAC (blended)	≤ £60

RETENTION & HEALTH METRICS

METRIC	TARGET
Monthly Churn Rate	≤ 4%
Net Revenue Retention	≥ 105%
NPS Score	≥ 45
Support Tickets / Venue	≤ 0.5/mo
Starter → Pro Upgrade Rate	≥ 30%
LTV:CAC	≥ 6x
Annual Billing Adoption	≥ 30% of new subs

> Annual subscribers transact once vs 12× monthly — reducing processing costs ~33% per customer. Annual cohorts also show near-zero monthly churn, materially improving LTV.

RISKS & MITIGATIONS

We know the risks. Here's the plan.

Four primary risks identified, each with a concrete mitigation strategy built into the GTM plan.

RISK	MITIGATION
Slow trial-to-paid conversion due to low tech adoption in independent hospitality	Concierge onboarding for first 100 venues. White-glove setup call. Reduce time-to-value below 15 minutes.
Larger competitor (Trail, Hospitality Gem) responds by adding compliance features	Price moat is durable. Offline-first architecture takes months to replicate. Move fast to lock in referral partnerships.
High churn from Starter tier (£5/mo venues with low switching cost)	Actively move Starter users to Pro within 90 days via in-app upsell. Pro users have higher stickiness due to rota dependency.
CAC higher than modelled due to competitive paid search landscape	SEO and referral channels are primary at launch. Paid ads activated at Phase 2 only after organic channels are validated.

LET'S BUILD THIS TOGETHER

The market is ready. The product is live.

£150k unlocks 18 months of runway to prove the model and position Pelikn as the default operations platform for independent hospitality in the UK.

RAISING	YEAR 2 ARR TARGET	GROSS MARGIN
£150,000	**£480k**	**87%**
Pre-Seed	1,600 venues × £25/mo avg	Software-grade unit economics

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